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The Ayurvedic Man

The Wellcome Collection examines the history of ‘alternative’ medicine in the Indian subcontinent

FEATURES

Bárbara Rodríguez Muñoz

30 OCTOBER 2017

There are many different approaches to health and the body in traditional Indian medicine; when I began immersing myself in the subject for an exhibition at the Wellcome Collection, I quickly realised that these myriad voices and sources of knowledge wouldn't begin to fit within the gallery walls. Narratives of health and their associated cultural expressions in India have shaped and been shaped by Greco-Islamic, Tibetan, Persian, and European influences, among others. Through such encounters, they have morphed and expanded, acquiring new meaning, or have been misinterpreted and exoticised along

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and dietetics. Widely practised today in India and beyond, in early 20th-century India a more homogenised ‘modern Ayurveda’ emerged as a response to the rise of medical science and pharmaceuticals during colonial rule. From the 1970s a ‘new age’ Ayurveda developed in the West alongside a growing market focussed on ‘wellness’ and lifestyle, with related products, literature, and activities available to purchase.

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of natural
history

Pietro di
Cristoforo Vanucci,
called il Perugino
estimate
€200,000 – 300,000



DOROTHEUM
SINCE 1707

Old Masters
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